# RATIONALISM

**RATIONALIST STARTING PROBLEM AND → CARTESIAN METHODIC DOUBT, COGITO → CARTESIAN KNOWLEDGE ARCHITECTURE AND → DESCARTES ON SUBSTANCE, INTERACTION → SPINOZA'S SUBSTANCE-ATTRIBUTE-MODE HIERARCHY AND → SPINOZA'S PARALLELISM AND ROUTE**

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

◆ PRIMARY CORE FLOW ◆ SUBORDINATE EXTRA ◆ APPROVAL / REVIEW

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g3 and all prior artifacts unchanged

## 00 — RATIONALIST STARTING PROBLEM AND CONNECTED 3-1-INFINITY SEQUENCE

RATIONALIST STARTING PROBLEM AND CONNECTED 3-1-INFINITY SEQUENCE · CAN REASON SECURE NECESSARY KNOWLEDGE AND AN INTELLIGIBLE WORLD? · A PRIORI PRINCIPLES + INTUITION + DEDUCTION · SUBSTANCE, ATTRIBUTE, MODE AND SUFFICIENT EXPLANATION · GOD + MIND + BODY · INTERACTION PROBLEM · ONE GOD/NATURE · PARALLELISM + NECESSITY

CENTRAL QUESTION: CAN REASON SECURE NECESSARY KNOWLEDGE AND AN INTELLIGIBLE WORLD? → METHOD: a priori principles + intuition + deduction → METAPHYSICS: substance, attribute, mode and sufficient explanation → DESCARTES: God + mind + body → interaction problem → SPINOZA: one God/Nature → parallelism + necessity → individuality problem

**SOURCE / DOCTRINE**
- CENTRAL QUESTION: CAN REASON SECURE NECESSARY KNOWLEDGE AND AN INTELLIGIBLE WORLD?
- METHOD: a priori principles + intuition + deduction
- METAPHYSICS: substance, attribute, mode and sufficient explanation

**ARGUMENT / MECHANISM**
- DESCARTES: God + mind + body → interaction problem
- SPINOZA: one God/Nature → parallelism + necessity → individuality problem
- LEIBNIZ: many monads → harmony + contingency → economy and evil problem

**IMPLICATION / VERDICT**
- MEMORY: substance 3-1-infinity; mind-body I-P-H.

**MECHANISM / VERDICT —** A shared demand for intelligibility produces different systems because independence, simplicity and individuation are interpreted differently.

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Rationalism is unified by confidence in a priori reason but divided by the criterion of substance, which moves from Cartesian dualism through Spinozist monism to Leibnizian monadic pluralism.**

## 01 — CARTESIAN METHODIC DOUBT, COGITO AND FIRST CERTAINTY

CARTESIAN METHODIC DOUBT, COGITO AND FIRST CERTAINTY · FOUR METHOD RULES · SIMPLE-TO-COMPLEX ORDER · COMPLETE REVIEW · SENSE ERROR · DREAM ARGUMENT · EVIL-GENIUS HYPOTHESIS SUSPEND EVERY BELIEF THAT CAN BE DOUBTED · I AM, I EXIST WHENEVER I THINK IMMEDIATE INTUITION

FOUR METHOD RULES: evidence → division → simple-to-complex order → complete review → SENSE ERROR → DREAM ARGUMENT → EVIL-GENIUS HYPOTHESIS suspend every belief that can be doubted → COGITO: I AM, I EXIST WHENEVER I THINK immediate intuition, not a syllogism → clear and distinct perception becomes the model → intuition supplies first principles; deduction orders consequences

**SOURCE / DOCTRINE**
- FOUR METHOD RULES: evidence → division → simple-to-complex order → complete review
- SENSE ERROR → DREAM ARGUMENT → EVIL-GENIUS HYPOTHESIS suspend every belief that can be doubted

**ARGUMENT / MECHANISM**
- COGITO: I AM, I EXIST WHENEVER I THINK immediate intuition, not a syllogism
- clear and distinct perception becomes the model

**IMPLICATION / VERDICT**
- intuition supplies first principles; deduction orders consequences
- LIMIT: present thinking is certain; enduring res cogitans needs further argument.

**MECHANISM / VERDICT —** The attempt to doubt thinking existence performs the very thinking whose existence it tries to deny.

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The cogito defeats radical doubt performatively; deception may falsify what is thought, but it cannot erase the occurrence and existence of the thinker while thinking.**

## 02 — CARTESIAN KNOWLEDGE ARCHITECTURE AND CIRCLE OBJECTION

CARTESIAN KNOWLEDGE ARCHITECTURE AND CIRCLE OBJECTION · MATHEMATICS AND EXTERNAL RES EXTENSA · FACTITIOUS; OBJECTIVE REALITY · REPRESENTATIONAL CONTENT · CAUSAL ADEQUACY OR TRADEMARK ROUTE + ONTOLOGICAL ROUTE; PRESENT · INTELLECT JUDGES EXTENDED, FLEXIBLE, CHANGEABLE IDENTITY BEYOND SENSORY QUALITIES · CLEAR/DISTINCT PREMISES PROVE GOD · GOD GUARANTEES CLEAR/DISTINCT TRUTH

**DOCTRINE / CLAIM**
- COGITO → IDEAS → GOD → NON-DECEPTION → MATHEMATICS AND EXTERNAL RES EXTENSA
- IDEAS: innate / adventitious / factitious; objective reality = representational content
- GOD: causal adequacy or trademark route + ontological route; present cautiously

**OBJECTION / PRESSURE**
- WAX: intellect judges extended, flexible, changeable identity beyond sensory qualities
- CIRCLE: clear/distinct premises prove God → God guarantees clear/distinct truth
- REPLY: present intuition compels; God secures memory and extended reasoning

**REPLY / RESIDUAL**
- RESIDUAL: the divine proofs themselves use inferential premises
- WORLD: involuntary sensory ideas require an active cause; veracity blocks deception
- LIMIT: body-existence is stronger than exact resemblance of sensible qualities.

**MECHANISM / VERDICT —** A perfect non-deceiving God is used to guarantee that what is clearly and distinctly perceived remains trustworthy beyond immediate attention.

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: God is the epistemic hinge of Cartesian reconstruction because divine non-deception extends clear and distinct certainty beyond the cogito, yet that hinge creates the Cartesian Circle.**

## 03 — DESCARTES ON SUBSTANCE, INTERACTION AND FREEDOM

DESCARTES ON SUBSTANCE, INTERACTION AND FREEDOM · INFINITE SUBSTANCE, ABSOLUTELY INDEPENDENT · RES COGITANS · ATTRIBUTE THOUGHT; MODES INCLUDE IDEAS AND VOLITIONS · RES EXTENSA · ATTRIBUTE EXTENSION; MODES INCLUDE SHAPE AND MOTION · REAL DISTINCTION · CLEAR CONCEPTION OF EACH WITHOUT THE OTHER

GOD = INFINITE SUBSTANCE, ABSOLUTELY INDEPENDENT

RES COGITANS: attribute thought; modes include ideas and volitions → RES EXTENSA: attribute extension; modes include shape and motion → REAL DISTINCTION: clear conception of each without the other

**SOURCE / DOCTRINE**
- GOD = INFINITE SUBSTANCE, ABSOLUTELY INDEPENDENT
- RES COGITANS: attribute thought; modes include ideas and volitions
- RES EXTENSA: attribute extension; modes include shape and motion
- REAL DISTINCTION: clear conception of each without the other

**ARGUMENT / MECHANISM**
- SUBSTANTIAL UNION: one embodied person experiences cross-domain coordination
- OBJECTION: how can unextended mind cause extended motion? causal-closure pressure
- REPLY: primitive notion of union; RESIDUAL: no transparent mechanism
- OTHER MINDS: inferred through embodied behaviour, not given by the cogito

**IMPLICATION / VERDICT**
- FREEDOM: will assents or withholds; error occurs when will outruns intellect
- LIMIT: created substances depend continuously on God.

**MECHANISM / VERDICT —** Clear and distinct conceivability supports real distinction, while the human union is treated as a primitive lived fact rather than a third substance.

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Cartesian dualism gains conceptual clarity by separating thought from extension, but its success in distinction becomes its central causal problem because heterogeneous substances must still explain one life.**

## 04 — SPINOZA'S SUBSTANCE-ATTRIBUTE-MODE HIERARCHY AND IMMANENT GOD

SPINOZA'S SUBSTANCE-ATTRIBUTE-MODE HIERARCHY AND IMMANENT GOD · ONE SELF-CAUSED, NECESSARILY EXISTING, ABSOLUTELY INFINITE SUBSTANCE · = DEUS SIVE NATURA INFINITELY MANY ATTRIBUTES HUMANS KNOW · IMMANENT CAUSE; WHATEVER IS, IS IN GOD; NO EXTERNAL · ACOSMISM; REPLY · MODES RETAIN DEPENDENT REALITY.

ONE SELF-CAUSED, NECESSARILY EXISTING, ABSOLUTELY INFINITE SUBSTANCE

= DEUS SIVE NATURA infinitely many ATTRIBUTES humans know THOUGHT and EXTENSION finite minds and → GOD = immanent cause; whatever is, is in God; no external created realm → OBJECTION: acosmism; REPLY: modes retain dependent reality.

**SOURCE / DOCTRINE**
- ONE SELF-CAUSED, NECESSARILY EXISTING, ABSOLUTELY INFINITE SUBSTANCE
- = DEUS SIVE NATURA infinitely many ATTRIBUTES humans know THOUGHT and EXTENSION finite minds and bodies are MODES

**ARGUMENT / MECHANISM**
- GOD = immanent cause; whatever is, is in God; no external created realm
- OBJECTION: acosmism; REPLY: modes retain dependent reality.

**IMPLICATION / VERDICT**
- ONE SELF-CAUSED, NECESSARILY EXISTING, ABSOLUTELY INFINITE SUBSTANCE
- = DEUS SIVE NATURA infinitely many ATTRIBUTES humans know THOUGHT and EXTENSION finite minds and bodies are MODES

**MECHANISM / VERDICT —** Because substance is conceived through itself and cannot be limited by another substance of the same nature, the system culminates in one infinite substance.

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Spinoza radicalises the Cartesian definition of substance until only God or Nature remains self-conceived, making minds and bodies dependent modes rather than independently interacting things.**

## 05 — SPINOZA'S PARALLELISM AND ROUTE FROM BONDAGE TO FREEDOM

SPINOZA'S PARALLELISM AND ROUTE FROM BONDAGE TO FREEDOM · ONE EVENT · UNDER THOUGHT · UNDER EXTENSION · ORDER AND CONNECTION OF IDEAS · ORDER AND CONNECTION OF THINGS · NO CROSS-ATTRIBUTE CAUSAL TRANSFER; PARALLELISM REPLACES CARTESIAN INTERACTION · FINITE MODES ARE NECESSARILY CAUSED; CONTINGENCY RECORDS IGNORANCE OF

ONE EVENT — under THOUGHT: idea — under EXTENSION: body-state

ORDER AND CONNECTION OF IDEAS = ORDER AND CONNECTION OF THINGS → NO cross-attribute causal transfer; parallelism replaces Cartesian interaction → FINITE MODES are necessarily caused; contingency records ignorance of causes

**SOURCE / DOCTRINE**
- ONE EVENT — under THOUGHT: idea — under EXTENSION: body-state
- ORDER AND CONNECTION OF IDEAS = ORDER AND CONNECTION OF THINGS
- NO cross-attribute causal transfer; parallelism replaces Cartesian interaction

**ARGUMENT / MECHANISM**
- FINITE MODES are necessarily caused; contingency records ignorance of causes
- CONATUS = each thing's striving to persevere in being
- INADEQUATE IDEAS + external causes → passive affects → BONDAGE

**IMPLICATION / VERDICT**
- COMMON NOTIONS / REASON / INTUITION → ADEQUATE IDEAS → ACTIVITY
- FREEDOM = acting from understood nature within necessity, not uncaused choice
- LIMIT: autonomy survives, but alternative possibilities do not.

**MECHANISM / VERDICT —** The same modal event is expressed under Thought as an idea and under Extension as a body-state, eliminating cross-attribute causal transfer.

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Spinoza reconciles freedom with determinism by treating freedom not as uncaused choice but as adequate self-determination within the necessary order of God or Nature.**

## 06 — LEIBNIZ'S MONAD HIERARCHY, PERCEPTION AND INDIVIDUALITY

LEIBNIZ'S MONAD HIERARCHY, PERCEPTION AND INDIVIDUALITY · WHY MONADS? EXTENSION IS DIVISIBLE; ULTIMATE SUBSTANCE MUST BE · NECESSARY SUPREME MONAD · COMPLETE INTELLIGENCE · RATIONAL SPIRITS · APPERCEPTION + REASON + MORAL AGENCY · ANIMAL SOULS · MEMORY + CLEARER PERCEPTION

WHY MONADS? extension is divisible; ultimate substance must be simple

GOD: necessary supreme monad / complete intelligence → RATIONAL SPIRITS: apperception + reason + moral agency → ANIMAL SOULS: memory + clearer perception

**SOURCE / DOCTRINE**
- WHY MONADS? extension is divisible; ultimate substance must be simple
- GOD: necessary supreme monad / complete intelligence
- RATIONAL SPIRITS: apperception + reason + moral agency

**ARGUMENT / MECHANISM**
- ANIMAL SOULS: memory + clearer perception
- BARE MONADS: obscure petites perceptions
- EVERY MONAD: simple, unextended, windowless, perceptive and appetitive

**IMPLICATION / VERDICT**
- APPETITION = internal transition; each perspective expresses the universe
- IDENTITY OF INDISCERNIBLES secures uniqueness
- BODIES = well-founded phenomena, not ultimate substances.

**MECHANISM / VERDICT —** Appetition moves each monad from one perception to another according to its own law, while its perspective differentiates it from every other monad.

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Leibniz makes substance simple and active: each monad is a unique perspectival centre whose internally unfolding perceptions preserve individuality without material parts or causal influx.**

## 07 — LEIBNIZIAN HARMONY, SUFFICIENT REASON, CONTINGENCY AND FREEDOM

LEIBNIZIAN HARMONY, SUFFICIENT REASON, CONTINGENCY AND FREEDOM · GOD CHOOSES A COMPOSSIBLE BEST WORLD UNDER THE PRINCIPLE · MIND-MONAD STATES UNFOLD INTERNALLY · BODILY/ORGANIC STATES UNFOLD INTERNALLY · PRE-ESTABLISHED HARMONY MAKES THEM CORRESPOND WITHOUT INTERACTION · TRUTHS OF REASON · OPPOSITE CONTRADICTORY · LOGICALLY NECESSARY

GOD chooses a compossible best world under the PRINCIPLE OF SUFFICIENT REASON

mind-monad states unfold internally → bodily/organic states unfold internally → PRE-ESTABLISHED HARMONY makes them correspond without interaction

**SOURCE / DOCTRINE**
- GOD chooses a compossible best world under the PRINCIPLE OF SUFFICIENT REASON
- mind-monad states unfold internally
- bodily/organic states unfold internally
- PRE-ESTABLISHED HARMONY makes them correspond without interaction

**ARGUMENT / MECHANISM**
- TRUTHS OF REASON: opposite contradictory → logically necessary
- TRUTHS OF FACT: opposite conceivable → contingent though certain
- COMPLETE CONCEPT: all predicates belong to the individual known fully by God
- FREEDOM: spontaneity + intelligence + contingency; reasons incline, not coerce

**IMPLICATION / VERDICT**
- OBJECTION: programming/evil; REPLY: self-expression + optimal compossibility
- LIMIT: compatibility is stronger than libertarian freedom.

**MECHANISM / VERDICT —** God chooses a compossible world and creates monads whose internally lawful sequences correspond without causal exchange.

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Leibniz preserves freedom by distinguishing certainty from absolute necessity: rational actions arise spontaneously from the agent's own reasons, which incline without necessitating in the logical sense.**

## 08 — THREE RATIONALIST SYSTEMS COMPARED ON MATCHED AXES

THREE RATIONALIST SYSTEMS COMPARED ON MATCHED AXES · LEIBNIZ SUBSTANCE · GOD + MIND + BODY · ONE GOD OR NATURE · MANY SIMPLE MONADS · IMMANENT REALITY · SELECTOR/COORDINATOR MIND-BODY · HARMONY ORDER

| SYSTEM / DOCTRINE | DECISIVE DISTINCTION | EVALUATION / TRAP |
|---|---|---|
| LEIBNIZ substance | selector/coordinator mind-body | rational assent |
| God + mind + body | harmony order | adequate activity |
| one God or Nature | mechanism + will | intelligent spontaneity |
| many simple monads | strict necessity | PRESSURE SEQUENCE: interaction gap → monist unity → restored individuality. |

**SYSTEM / DOCTRINE**
- LEIBNIZ substance
- God + mind + body
- one God or Nature
- many simple monads
- immanent reality

**DECISIVE DISTINCTION**
- selector/coordinator mind-body
- harmony order
- mechanism + will
- strict necessity
- certain/contingent freedom

**EVALUATION / TRAP**
- rational assent
- adequate activity
- intelligent spontaneity
- PRESSURE SEQUENCE: interaction gap → monist unity → restored individuality.

**MECHANISM / VERDICT —** Each successor accepts the Cartesian pressure but redistributes substance and causation to avoid direct interaction between heterogeneous realities.

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Spinoza removes the interaction gap by collapsing Cartesian substances into attributes of one order, while Leibniz restores plurality by replacing interaction with divinely coordinated internal activity.**

## 09 — CRITICISM-REPLY LEDGER, TRAPS, PYQ ROUTES AND ANSWER SPINE

CRITICISM-REPLY LEDGER, TRAPS, PYQ ROUTES AND ANSWER SPINE · INTERACTION GAP · PRIMITIVE UNION · MECHANISM REMAINS OPAQUE · ADEQUATE ACTIVITY + MODAL REALITY · NO ALTERNATIVES · SPONTANEITY + POSSIBLE WORLDS · RESIDUAL PRESSURE

DESCARTES: interaction gap → primitive union → mechanism remains opaque → SPINOZA: necessity/acosmism → adequate activity + modal reality → no alternatives → LEIBNIZ: programming/evil/economy → spontaneity + possible worlds → residual pressure → PRECISION: substance != attribute != mode; mind != person; necessity != fatalism → PRECISION: spontaneity != autonomy; compatibilism != libertarian freedom

**DOCTRINE / CLAIM**
- DESCARTES: interaction gap → primitive union → mechanism remains opaque
- SPINOZA: necessity/acosmism → adequate activity + modal reality → no alternatives
- LEIBNIZ: programming/evil/economy → spontaneity + possible worlds → residual pressure
- PRECISION: substance != attribute != mode; mind != person; necessity != fatalism

**OBJECTION / PRESSURE**
- PRECISION: spontaneity != autonomy; compatibilism != libertarian freedom
- PYQ ROUTES: certainty/self-world; substance 3-1-infinity; pantheism; freedom
- PYQ ROUTES: innate ideas; monads/harmony; God; determination/negation
- ANSWER SPINE

**REPLY / RESIDUAL**
- directive → thesis → definitions → argument → example → objection → reply → verdict
- CONTROL: claim → named evidence → analysis → qualification
- VERDICT: intelligibility is gained at recurring costs to interaction and autonomy.

**MECHANISM / VERDICT —** Precision turns system summaries into answers by linking every doctrine to a named inferential role and an explicit qualification.

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: A criticism-reply answer spine reveals rationalism's central tension: systematic intelligibility repeatedly pressures interaction, contingency and autonomous individuality.**

## E — SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

EXTRA · OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT · ADVANCED SESSION 1 — RATIONALISM MASTER MAP AND BASIC · ADVANCED SESSION 2 — CARTESIAN DOUBT, COGITO AND CERTAIN · ADVANCED SESSION 3 — WAX, EXTERNAL WORLD, DIVINE GUARANTEE · ADVANCED SESSION 4 — SUBSTANCE · ONE INHERITED CRITERION, DESCARTES 3, SPINOZA 1, LEIBNIZ INFINITY · ADVANCED SESSION 5 — GOD · CARTESIAN GUARANTEE, SPINOZIST IMMANENT NATURE, LEIBNIZIAN SELECTOR

**OPTIONAL SOURCE WITNESS**
- ADVANCED SESSION 1 — Rationalism Master Map and Basic Tenets
- ADVANCED SESSION 2 — Cartesian Doubt, Cogito and Certain Self-Knowledge
- ADVANCED SESSION 3 — Wax, External World, Divine Guarantee and the Cartesian Circle
- ADVANCED SESSION 4 — Substance: One Inherited Criterion, Descartes 3, Spinoza 1, Leibniz Infinity

**ADVANCED OBJECTION**
- ADVANCED SESSION 5 — God: Cartesian Guarantee, Spinozist Immanent Nature, Leibnizian Selector
- ADVANCED SESSION 6 — Mind and Body: Interactionism, Parallelism and Pre-Established Harmony
- ADVANCED SESSION 7 — Freedom and Determinism Across the Rationalist Trio
- ADVANCED SESSION 8 — Spinoza's Integrated System: Necessity, Knowledge, Pantheism and Negation

**COMPARATIVE NUANCE**
- ADVANCED SESSION 9 — Leibniz: Monads, Sufficient Reason, Contingency and Harmony
- ADVANCED SESSION 10 — Criticisms, Comparisons, PYQ Routing and Provenance-Safe Answer Architecture
- ADVANCED DOSSIER REFINEMENTS — USE SELECTIVELY
- Core prerequisite : finish the owner first for Cartesian Method and Certain Knowledge

**OPTIONAL STATUS —** This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels